# DORETTE

## CROCHET STUDIO

# Illustrated User Guide

### Version 1.4.0

Create an accurate stitch chart, refine it with editable layers, then crochet each row confidently - using only your device.

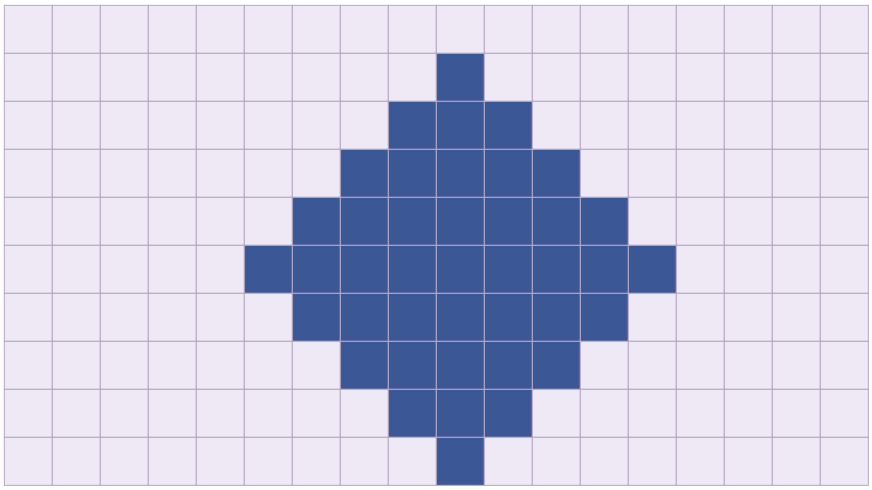


**Photo conversion • Colorwork • Layers • Guided crochet**

Local-first design | Project ZIP backups | Offline-capable app

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# Getting started and workspace modes

## Three clear workspaces

### CREATE

Import photos, add lettering and motifs.

### EDIT

Paint, clean, arrange layers and validate.

### CROCHET

Follow rows, mark stitches and track progress.

## A good first project

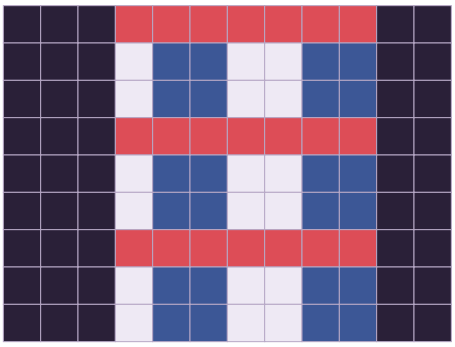
1. Choose New crochet project and enter its width in columns and height in rows.
2. Row 1 is always the bottom row; Column 1 is on the left.
3. Make a small 10 by 10 practice chart first, then experiment with paint, text, Undo and the dual-chart view.
4. Switch Create / Edit / Crochet from the main workspace navigation. Your stitches are not erased when changing modes.

**Helpful detail**

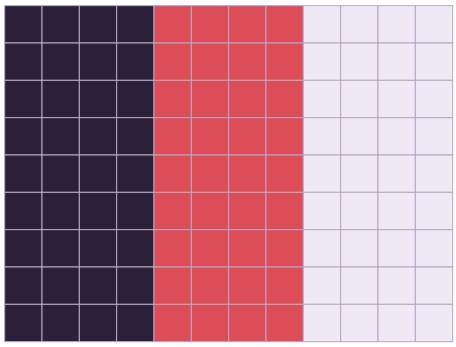
Use the overview chart to find your place; use the working chart for zoomed editing. Single chart gives more room when necessary.

# Importing images and grayscale

## From a colorful photograph to yarn shades



**Imported color artwork**



**3-shade crochet interpretation**

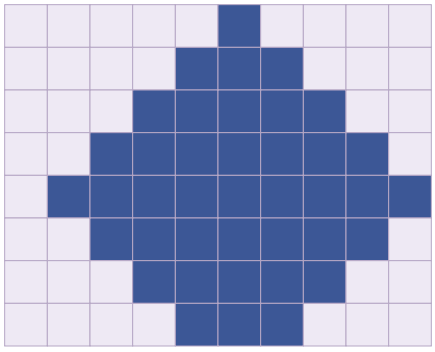
1. In Create, import a photo and crop the subject or artwork carefully.
2. Choose Clean printed artwork for flat prints, Natural image palette for color images, or Grayscale for monochrome yarn.
3. For grayscale, select 2, 3, 4 or 5 shades of black, white and gray. Use Compare 2-color vs 4-color to see the tradeoff.
4. Preview stitches before applying. Applying a new palette to an existing layered chart requires confirmation.

**Helpful detail**

Fewer shades are easier to crochet but lose some detail. Adjust brightness and contrast on the preview, not by permanently editing the original photo.

# Smart cleanup and pattern checker

## Preview cleanup before changing a single stitch



### Example pattern review

- Isolated single stitches
- Tiny color islands

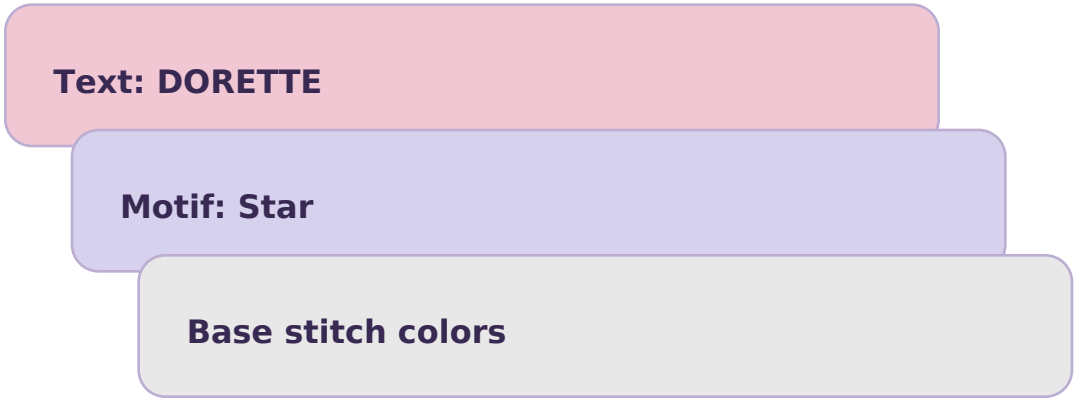
1. Choose Smart cleanup & quality from Edit.
2. Select an area and tick Protect selected area to preserve small facial details, lettering or intentional accents.
3. Choose a cleanup size, then Preview cleanup: proposed changes appear in orange on the chart.
4. Apply fixes only if the preview is acceptable. Use Undo immediately if you change your mind.
5. Run Check pattern quality to count color changes, small patches, empty rows and border colors.

### Helpful detail

Cleanup affects the base color grid; editable layers remain separate. Quality warnings are suggestions, not errors.

# Editable layers

## Each object can stay separate from the chart beneath



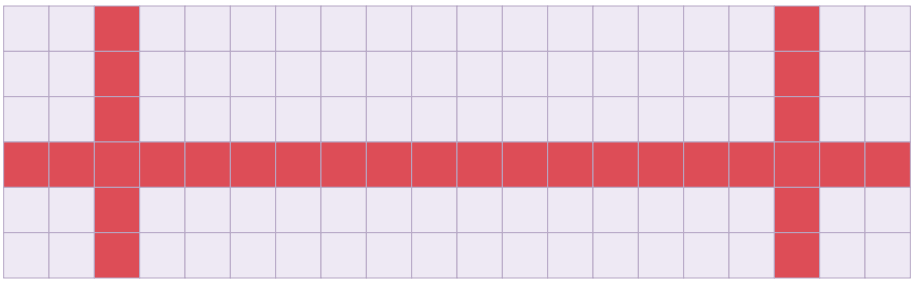

1. Apply lettering or a reusable motif. New content is stored as an editable layer instead of replacing the underlying colors.
2. Select a layer in the list. Use the visibility and lock controls, or reorder it with Bring forward and Send backward.
3. Duplicate, move with arrow buttons, or Edit a text layer to resize, recolor and reposition it.
4. Flatten selected permanently merges its visible stitches into the base chart. Undo can restore the separate layer.

**Helpful detail**

Layer order matters: the upper visible layer covers the stitch colors beneath it. The printable chart uses the composed result.

# Advanced lettering studio

## Make lettering that fits the stitch grid



Example: bold lettering mapped to square stitches

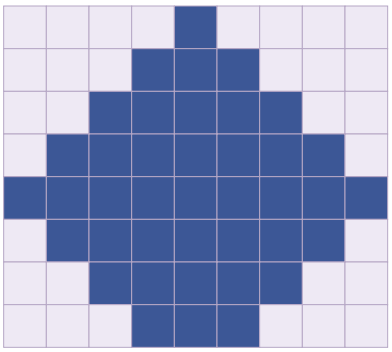
1. Type letters, numbers or symbols, then choose Classic block, Bold block or Outline only.
2. Change letter height, spacing, wrapping, straight/diagonal/curved layout, rotation or mirror.
3. Use Center text to place the design centrally, or select an area and choose Auto-fit text to selected area.
4. Preview the text first, then tap Apply. The result becomes a separate, editable text layer.
5. If the preview does not fit, move it inward or reduce the letter size. The Studio rejects clipped text when applying.

### Helpful detail

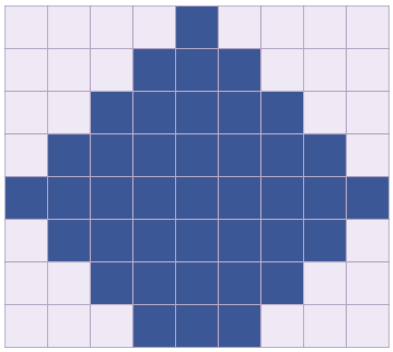
Use the selected text layer and Edit layer to revise lettering later. You do not need to erase a finished word from the base pattern.

# Motifs, symmetry and repetition

## Fast patterns with reusable geometry



**Original motif**



**Repeated / repositioned motif**

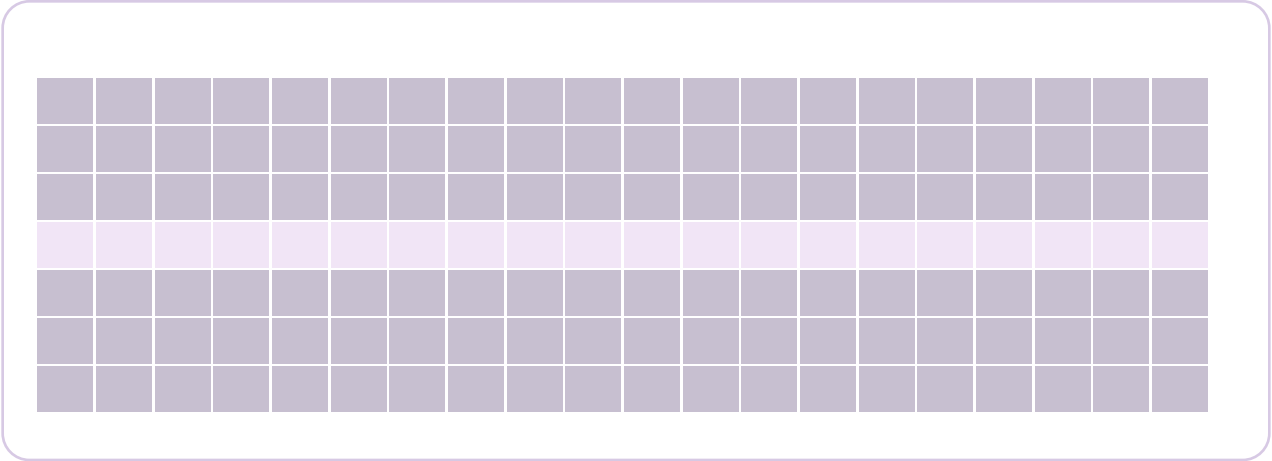
1. Use Select area to outline a set of stitches, then Save selected area as motif.
2. Choose a saved motif and preview placement. Rotate, flip, move and apply it as an editable layer.
3. Use Repeat selected area to copy a region horizontally or vertically with a chosen number of repetitions.
4. Turn on symmetry while painting: mirror left/right, top/bottom, or both. The same brush stroke is reflected.

**Helpful detail**

The reusable motif library lives locally in the browser. Motifs already applied as layers are included in the project backup.

# Crochet View and Row Spotlight

## A less distracting chart when crocheting



Only the current guide row remains bright; surrounding rows are dimmed.

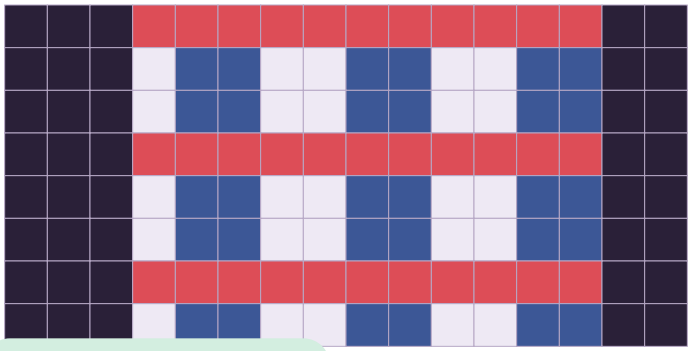
1. Switch to Crochet workspace or tap Resume crocheting.
2. Turn on Row Spotlight to dim all other rows. Your current guide row remains easy to follow.
3. Use Go to square to jump directly to a row and column at the current zoom.
4. Keep the chart locked while you follow instructions to avoid accidental color changes.

**Helpful detail**

The guide controls stay docked near the chart. Spotlight affects screen display only: no yarn colors or PDF output are changed.

# Completion and guided crochet

## Marking progress never changes the actual yarn color



DONE ✓

1. Guided Crochet Mode shows your row, stitch, current yarn and the next color run.
2. Complete & next advances by one stitch. Complete color run advances through consecutive stitches in the same yarn.
3. Use Mark stitch or Mark row to shade completed work. Undo progress reverses the latest completion action.
4. Pattern Lock prevents editing the stitch colors while still allowing progress and navigation.
5. Show/hide the progress overlay any time: the colored pattern remains unchanged beneath the marks.

**Helpful detail**

Row 1 starts at the bottom. If the directions alternate by row, the Studio follows the left-to-right or right-to-left setting you selected.

# Personal yarn library

## Save favorite skeins once, reuse them across projects



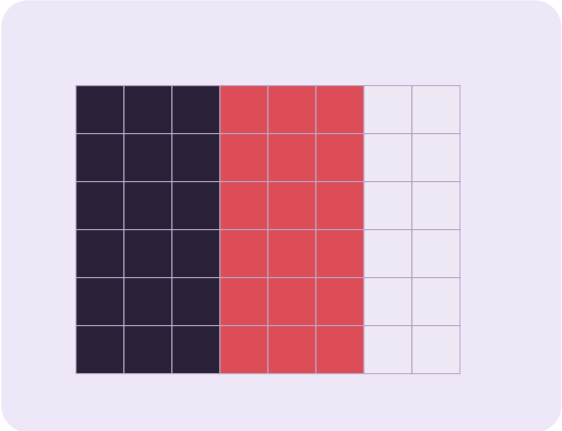

1. In Yarn color legend, choose a yarn used in your chart.
2. Enter the yarn brand, color code, dye lot, skein size and other inventory information in the yarn settings.
3. Choose Save selected yarn in Personal yarn library.
4. In another project, select the saved yarn and Use saved yarn. If the color is already present, the Studio selects it rather than adding a duplicate.

**Helpful detail**

The library lives in this browser and is not automatically synchronized to another tablet or laptop. Save the original projects and consider taking notes of favorite yarn codes.

# Finished size and yarn estimates

## Estimate fabric dimensions from a swatch



**Example**

20 stitches × 20 rows = 4 × 4 in

80 columns × 100 rows →

**16 × 20 inches**

1. Crochet a real swatch with the intended yarn, hook size and stitch technique.
2. Count the swatch stitches and rows and measure its width and height.
3. Enter these values into Finished size calculator, choosing inches or centimeters.
4. For yarn quantity estimates, enter measured yards used for a known number of stitches in Yarn inventory.

**Helpful detail**

Estimates depend on tension and stitch type. Always make a real swatch before buying yarn or sizing fitted clothing.

# Printable PDF and ZIP backups

## Export patterns and preserve project data

### PRINTABLE PDF

- Numbered chart pages
- Optional overlap / symbols
- Written row instructions

### PROJECT ZIP BACKUP

- Stitch cells and progress
- Yarn and editable layers
- Reference images if attached

1. For paper patterns, choose Letter or A4, orientation, stitch size, and overlap. Download printable PDF or written row instructions.
2. For safety, use Back up all to export a private ZIP containing your projects. Store it in Google Drive or another safe location.
3. Restore a PROJECT backup ZIP inside the Studio. Restoring makes new copies instead of replacing existing projects.
4. When updating your GitHub Pages site, upload the application update ZIP contents; do not feed that software ZIP to Restore.

**Helpful detail**

Browser projects are kept on the same device, browser profile and site address. Do not clear site storage; do not share personal project backups publicly.

# Help, tutorials and troubleshooting

## Short built-in tutorials plus section help

**? Guided tour • Context help • This illustrated PDF**

Use the new guided tour from the Studio header. Its short steps introduce the three workspaces, image conversion, layers, cleanup, crochet progress and backups.

1. If something is confusing, tap the nearby ? help button.
2. If an edit looks wrong, use Undo. For progress marks, use Undo progress.
3. If a photo conversion loses detail, increase the chart resolution or reduce color reduction.
4. If text gets cut off, use a smaller size, move it inward, or choose Auto-fit with a selected area.
5. If the website shows an older version after updating, reopen it online and check the version badge. Keep your same browser profile and website address.

**Future features (not yet included)**

Hands-free voice controls and automatic cloud backup/recovery are intentionally not part of this release.